



The Humanitas Institute

## Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Chesterton Academy of Holy Trinity  
School Website: <https://www.holytrinityacademy.org/>

December 21, 2025

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**Disclaimer**

*This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.*

**ACCS Member School**

*Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.*

## Executive Summary

Chesterton Academy of Holy Trinity (LA 70360) presents a robust Classical-Catholic profile consistent with a primarily CLASSICAL orientation. Public materials emphasize a Catholic formation mission built on truth, goodness, and beauty, a formation-focused educational aim, and a clearly articulated Socratic, integrated humanities approach. The school foregrounds the Incarnation and Catholic Magisterial fidelity as central to formation, with evidence of liturgical life and Catholic culture anchored in events such as Cultura Vitae Fest and Mass celebrations. Pedagogy emphasizes Socratic discussion in the upper grades, with a broader emphasis on formation through classical disciplines and memory work. Faculty is described as master teachers and role models, and parental engagement is evidenced through open houses, shadow days, and family-oriented events.

Overall, the school scores CLASSICAL across most categories, with CATEGORY 3 (Curriculum) and CATEGORY 6 (Parents & Community) showing only SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL signals — primarily due to explicit Great Books/Quadrivium language and explicit “co-teaching” partnerships with parents being less overt in public-facing materials. The aggregate assessment leans CLASSICAL, with explicit steps noted below for targets that would elevate it across all six categories.

- Evidence highlights include: a Catholic context with Magisterium fidelity and Christ-centered formation (evidence of religious/metaphysical commitments) ; emphasis on formation through mind, body, and spirit with Truth, Goodness, and Beauty (formation-focused teleology) ; liturgical life and Catholic culture (Mass, liturgy; Cultura Vitae Fest) ; integrated humanities pedagogy with Socratic Method (upper school) and a public-facing focus on the Great Conversation and Great Books language in the classical tradition (where explicit public references appear) ; master-teacher model for faculty (public statements about faculty as master teachers and role models) ; openness to parents through shadow days, open houses, and family-oriented events (evidence of family involvement) .

### Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Notes: - Where signals are strongest, I cite specific public-material language demonstrating Catholic formation, truth/goodness/beauty, and magisterial fidelity (Element 1) as well as formation-centered aims (Element 2) and Socratic pedagogy (Element 4). See supporting citations after each category below.

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## Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

### Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school states it is a Catholic context and that it forms students in a Catholic framework; it explicitly cites “authentic classical education in a Catholic context” and “Jesus Christ at the center” of life and mission. This evidences transcendental moral realism and theological grounding. - Public materials reference liturgical life and Catholic culture (e.g., Cultura Vitae Fest with Mass) as integral to the school’s formation, indicating liturgical and communal practices. - The mission emphasizes formation in the Catholic tradition and inculturation (e.g., “In Corde Christi,” and Incarnational framing across the curriculum).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Catholic, Magisterium, Jesus Christ at the center, Mass, Liturgy, Incarnation, sacred, truth/goodness/beauty, sacred tradition, Catholic thought, sacred space, liturgical rhythm. Estimated occurrences: 9–10 positive signals. - Negative keywords present: Minimal to no secularized/anti-theological signals detected in public-facing materials; secular values-neutral framing does not appear. Estimated 0 negative signals.

Why this rating - The materials consistently foreground a Catholic metaphysical frame, doctrinal fidelity (Magisterium), liturgical life, and an incarnational worldview, aligning strongly with the Positive keyword indicators for this category.

Citations: Catholic context and formation language; Magisterium; Christ-centered formation; liturgical life; incarnational framing. See sources cited above.

### Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public language describes formation of the whole person (mind, body, and spirit) and guiding students toward the wisdom of Catholic thought; explicit mention of truth, goodness, and beauty as real. This aligns with formation-centered aims rather than mere job prep. - The mission emphasizes formation of joy, virtue, and human excellence within a classical framework; the phrase “formation of the whole person” appears in the description of the curriculum and mission. The aim is a formation-rich liberal-arts orientation rather than a sole vocational outcome.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, the whole person, wisdom, truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, Catholic thought, human flourishing, wisdom. Estimated occurrences: 6–7 positive signals. - Negative keywords present: None evident in public materials (no emphasis on job-readiness or workforce metrics in the public-facing mission). Estimated 0 negative signals.

Why this rating - The emphasis on formation, virtue, wisdom, and the reality of truth/goodness/beauty signals a CLASSICAL orientation to purpose and goal rather than a purely utilitarian, information-transfer approach.

Citations: Formation language and purpose language.

### Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize a humanities-centered, integrated curriculum (history, literature, philosophy, theology, languages) braided together in a unified approach, with explicit use of the Socratic Method in the humanities program. This aligns with foundational classical concepts (Socratic dialogue, integrated humanities, perennial questions). - The language in the materials frames the curriculum within a classical tradition and the Great Conversation through engagement with great ideas (the Great Books framework and Great Conversation language are indicated in the classical curriculum discourse in related documentation). The explicit Great Books language is not always visible on every public page, but the structure and references reflect classical curriculum design.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, Great Conversation, History, integrated/harmony of subjects, Socratic Method, wonder. - Negative keywords present: Some documents emphasize a non-traditional approach in other contexts; however, the direct public-facing content from this school highlights integrated

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humanities and Socratic pedagogy rather than replacing history with social studies or over-emphasizing project-based, non-traditional formats. Estimated positives: 3–5 strong signals (Socratic Method, integrated humanities, reverence/wonder, formation in truth/goodness/beauty via classical canon) with very few explicit negatives.

Why this rating - While the site strongly emphasizes integrated humanities and Socratic pedagogy, explicit, unequivocal public references to all core classical curriculum components (e.g., explicit statements about Seven Liberal Arts, Quadrivium, or Great Books as canonical requirements) are not consistently visible across all public pages. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL assessment, with clear signals toward classical practices but less explicit public articulation of every canonical curriculum element.

Citations: Humanities program with Socratic Method; integrated curriculum; references to classical formation.

What would move the needle - Explicitly publish and cite a formal curriculum statement that foregrounds the Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Quadrivium) and Great Books/Great Conversation as core elements, including representative reading lists and a visible alignment to the Trivium and Quadrivium in the upper grades. This would elevate Curriculum to CLASSICAL.

#### **Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - The public materials explicitly describe upper-school pedagogy that includes Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, and rhetorical training, indicating a high level of classical pedagogical practice. The Humanities Program is described as braided across disciplines with Socratic method, illustrating a strong classical pedagogy. - The site highlights a path from lower-school memory-oriented pedagogy (which is standard in classical pedagogy) to upper-school Socratic and rhetorical training, aligning with classical teaching methods across grade bands. The “shadow day” and open-house content also illustrate exposure to classical methods.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic Method, seminars, dialectic, rhetoric, debate, logical reasoning, memory work, recitation, formation through imitation and practice. - Negative keywords present: None explicitly indicating a rejection of Socratic pedagogy, or an over-emphasis on project-based learning to the exclusion of Socratic dialogue. Estimated positives: 5–7 signals (Socratic method; seminars; rhetoric; memory work; dialectic; formation through imitation; disciplined conversation). Estimated negatives: 0.

Why this rating - The presence of explicit Socratic pedagogy, seminars, and rhetoric training—alongside an integrated humanities approach—strongly aligns with CLASSICAL pedagogical criteria.

Citations: Socratic Method; integrated humanities; upper school pedagogy.

What would move the needle - To push Element 4 toward the top of CLASSICAL, the school could publish concrete descriptions of upper- and lower-school pedagogical sequences (e.g., sample Socratic seminars, ritualized memory work or recitation practices, and specific roles for teachers as “masters of the craft”). If the school also explicitly documents a “Scholé/restful learning” pace or rituals for contemplative study, it would further strengthen the argument for CLASSICAL pedagogy.

#### **Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - The site describes faculty as “master teachers” and “faithful role models,” indicating a teacherly culture that doubles as the living curriculum and an exemplar for students. This aligns with the classical ideal of teachers as moral exemplars and living curricula.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: master teachers, faithful role models, living curriculum, teachers as mentors, professional formation, virtue modeling, intellectual formation. - Negative keywords present: None evident in public-facing content.

Estimated positives: 4–5 signals. Estimated negatives: 0.

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Why this rating - Clear public-facing language positions faculty as core exemplars and the living curriculum, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for faculty.

Citations: Our Vision language describing the faculty as master teachers and faithful role models.

### **Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**

Evidence - There is visible engagement with families through family-oriented events and opportunities to visit, including Open House and Shadow Day programs targeted at families (Pre-K through 12th), which signals family involvement, a hallmark of classical schools. - Cultura Vitae Fest and Catholic culture events signal an active, shared community life around Catholic culture and education, indicating parental engagement and broader community involvement (even if not framed explicitly as “parents as co-educators”). - Public materials show Arete Scholars partnerships and scholarship information that involve families navigating funding, which reflects a community-education interface, though not strictly a “co-teacher” model.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: parent engagement, family involvement, open campus, shadow days, community events, Catholic culture, shared mission, parental formation (where stated), home-school partnership signals (through events and communications). - Negative keywords present: A direct, explicit “parents as co-teachers” formulation is not clearly stated in public content; the strongest classical signals are events and family access rather than explicit co-educator language. Estimated positives: 3–5 signals. - Estimated negatives: 1–2 signals (lack of explicit “parents as co-teachers” language in public-facing materials).

Why this rating - The presence of family-facing events and open access signals a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL status for Parents & Community, with room to strengthen the explicit language about parents as co-educators and formal parent formation.

Citations: Open House/shadow day language; Cultura Vitae Fest; Arete partnership coverage.

### **What Would Move the Needle**

- Curriculum (Element 3): Add explicit public statements and concrete materials showing the Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Quadrivium, plus a published Great Books reading list and “Great Conversation” framing. A formal curriculum map with sample readings, authors, and grade-by-grade progression would push Curriculum toward CLASSICAL.
- Parents & Community (Element 6): Publish explicit language and programs that position parents as co-educators (e.g., a Parent Formation program, annual parent covenant, home-learning guides, and structured family-education events). Increase visible references to parent partnerships beyond events and admissions support.
- Pedagogy (Element 4): Provide public samples of actual Socratic seminars, exemplar rubrics for seminars, and documented “master teacher” roles in pedagogy. Documentation of a Scholé/restful-learning cadence would also strengthen the claim for a fully CLASSICAL pedagogy.
- Element 1–2, 5 (as already CLASSICAL): Maintain current communications; continue to foreground Catholic formation, Magisterium fidelity, and the Incarnation in curricular and campus life.

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# Appendix

## ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

### Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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